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Good Decision: Starting a cut (fat loss phase)

Circumstances:

I wasn't happy with how I looked. I had lost the confidence I once had and wanted to reclaim it. The cut helped me start eating clean again and paying attention to often-overlooked aspects like gut health and fiber intake.

Options:

There was really only one main path—committing to an aggressive calorie deficit (~1000 calories). However, using Macrofactor instead of manually tracking macros was an option that made the process more manageable.

Length:

I had been thinking about it for about a month. The turning point came during winter break after seeing my friends' physiques, which made me realize I had let myself go and needed to take action when the semester resumed.

Good/bad:

+4, It's had a strong positive impact, improving my discipline and how I feel overall. It's not the most life-changing decision I've made, but it ranks quite high.

Importance:

9, It was a necessary step for reaching my long-term fitness goals, particularly in calisthenics where strength-to-weight ratio is critical.

Satisfaction:

7, I'm happy with the progress I've made so far. There's still more to go, but every small win along the way feels rewarding.

Best:

10, Without a doubt, it was the best decision in the circumstances. It helped me regain control over my eating habits and become more conscious of nutrition, which has long-term value beyond just weight loss.

Bad Decision:**Circumstances:**

I was traveling with friends I hadn't seen in a while and wanted to be fully present. I assumed the first week of my summer class would be light and mostly introductory, so I made the decision to hold off on coursework until I returned.

Options:

I could've planned better and done assignments before leaving or at least checked in more regularly. Instead, I chose to ignore the course and focus on the trip, aside from one brief check a few days in that made me realize I had more due than expected.

Length:

The decision didn't take long—I knew before the trip I wanted to focus on relaxing and planned to dial back in once I was back.

Good/bad:

-3, Not a terrible decision, but if I hadn't checked in when I did, it would've been much worse.

Importance:

6, Somewhat important in terms of staying on top of my coursework, though not critical in the grand scheme of my degree.

Satisfaction:

5, I was able to enjoy the trip, but the sudden academic catch-up added stress and took time away from one of my days abroad.

Best:

6, I got to enjoy the moment, but a bit more planning could've made it smoother without cutting into the trip or my performance.